

THE WORSHIP OF GOD
Service Order 4

February 1, 2004

8:15 & 11:15 AM

Prelude & Pre-Worship Meditation

O God, may Thy Spirit speak in me that I may speak to Thee. I Lord Jesus, great high priest, Thou hast opened a new and living way by which a fallen creature can approach Thee with acceptance. Help me to contemplate the dignity of Thy Person, the perfectness of Thy sacrifice, the effectiveness of Thy intercession. O what blessedness accompanies devotion, when under all the trials that weary me, the cares that corrode me, the fears that disturb me, the infirmities that oppress me, I can come to Thee in my need and feel peace beyond understanding!

Taken from *The Valley of Vision: A Collection of Puritan Prayers & Devotions*,
edited by Arthur Bennett

Worship through Invocation and Adoration

Jesus, Lover of My Soul

Insert pg. 1 11:15AM

**This Is the Day the Lord Has Made*

Insert pg. 2 11:15AM

*Call to Worship: Psalm 29:1-9

Leader: Ascribe to the Lord, O mighty ones, ascribe to the Lord glory and strength.

People: ***Ascribe to the Lord glory due his name; worship the Lord in the splendor of his holiness.***

Leader: The voice of the Lord is over the waters; the God of glory thunders, the Lord thunders over the mighty waters.

People: ***The voice of the Lord is powerful; the voice of the Lord is majestic.***

Leader: The voice of the Lord breaks the cedars; the Lord breaks in pieces the cedars of Lebanon.

People: ***The voice of the Lord strikes with flashes of lightning.***

Leader: The voice of the Lord shakes the desert; the Lord shakes the Desert of Kadesh.

People: ***The voice of the Lord twists the oaks and strips the forests bare. And in his temple all cry, "Glory!"***

* Hymn: *Holy, Holy, Holy!*

#100

*Invocation and Prayer of Adoration

*Doxology (#733)

Praise God from whom all blessings flow;

Praise Him all creatures here below, Alleluia, Alleluia!

Praise Him above ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son and Holy Ghost;

O Praise Him! O Praise Him! Alleluia, Alleluia, Alleluia!

New Testament Reading: 2Corinthians 3

Reader: This is the Word of the Lord!

People: *Thanks be to God!*

Worship through Confession and Absolution

Corporate Confession

[participants may kneel or remain seated and lean forward]

Leader: Let us then confess our sins to God our Father.

Unison: *Our great and glorious God, You who know and judge the secrets of every human heart, we do acknowledge and confess that we have followed our father Adam in revolting against your commandments. We have turned from your ways and from your blessed Presence and have reaped the misery of turning away from You, the very Author of life. None of us is righteous, no not one. None of us has understanding, none of us seeks God. We use our tongues to deceive, our mouths are full of cursing and bitterness, our feet are swift to shed blood, ruin and misery are in our paths, and the way of peace we have not known. There is no fear of God before our eyes. We appeal to you, through your great mercy made manifest in Jesus Christ Your obedient Son, that you would forgive our sins for His sake, that you would make many righteous through His one act of obedience, that where our sin has increased, Your grace would abound. Just as Christ was raised from the dead by your glory, so also may we walk in newness of life. Amen.*

[Based upon Rom. 3]

Private confession

Leader: Hear now God's assurance of pardon:

For all have sinned and fallen short of the glory of God...For the wages of sin is death, but the free gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord.

Rom. 3. 23, 6:23

Pastoral Prayer

[participants may be seated]

The Collection of the Communion of Saints

For you know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that though he was rich, yet for your sake he became poor, so that you by his poverty might become rich.
2Corinthians 8:9

*Hymn of Thanksgiving: *How Firm A Foundation* #94 8:15AM
[A good time for children to leave for child care - located downstairs - if so desired.]

Song: *Thy Mercy My God is the Theme of My Song* Insert pg. 3
11:15AM

Worship through Word and Sacrament

Old Testament Reading: Exodus 20:1-21
Sermon: The "Stony-ness" of the Law

The Celebration of the Lord's Supper

Confession of Faith:
[participants may kneel or remain seated and lean forward]

Leader: Christians, what do you believe?

All: *We believe that God, who is perfectly merciful and just, sent His Son to assume our nature, and to bear the punishment of our sin by His most bitter passion and death. God manifested His justice against His Son when He laid our iniquities upon Him, and poured forth His mercy and goodness on us, who were guilty and worthy of damnation, giving His Son unto death for us, and raising Him for our justification, that through Him we might obtain immortality and life eternal. We believe that Jesus Christ has presented Himself in our behalf before the Father, to appease His wrath, by offering Himself on the tree of the cross, and pouring out His precious blood to purge away our sins. And therefore we always ascribe all the glory to God, humbling ourselves before Him, without presuming to trust in any merit of ours, relying and resting upon the obedience of Christ crucified alone, which becomes ours when we believe in Him. This is sufficient to cover all our iniquities, and to give us confidence in approaching to God; freeing our conscience of fear, terror, and dread. Wherefore we justly say with the apostle Paul that we know nothing save Jesus Christ, and him crucified; we count all things but loss for the excellency of the knowledge of Christ Jesus our Lord, in whose wounds we find all manner of consolation.*

Adapted from the Belgic Confession, 1561, Articles XX-XXII

Prayer of Consecration

[participants may be seated]

Words of Institution

Pastor: Therefore we proclaim the mystery of faith:

All: *Christ has died.*

Christ is risen.

Christ will come again.

Pastor: Alleluia! Christ our Passover is sacrificed for us;

All: *Therefore let us keep the feast. Alleluia!*

Pastor: The Gifts of God for the People of God.

Take them in remembrance that Christ died for you, and feed on him in your hearts by faith, with thanksgiving.

Distribution of Elements

[We use wine in the Lord’s Supper, believing it to be the biblical element used. We provide grape juice for those who, out of conscience or reasons of health, do not partake of wine. Grape juice is in the outer rim.]

Communion Hymn: How Sweet and Awesome Is the Place #469

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| 1. <i>How sweet and awesome is the place
with Christ within the doors,
while everlasting love displays
the choicest of her stores.</i> | 4. <i>Twas the same love that spread the feast
that sweetly drew us in;
else we had still refused to taste,
and perished in our sin.</i> |
| 2. <i>While all our hearts and all our songs
join to admire the feast,
each of us cries, with thankful tongue,
“Lord, why was I a guest?”</i> | 5. <i>Pity the nations, O our God,
constrain the earth to come;
send your victorious Word abroad,
and bring the strangers home.</i> |
| 3. <i>“Why was I made to hear your voice,
and enter while there’s room,
when thousands make a wretched choice,
and rather starve than come?”</i> | 6. <i>We long to see your churches full,
that all the chosen race
may, with one voice and heart and soul,
sing your redeeming grace.</i> |

Prayers for those not communing:

Prayer for those searching:

Oh God, I am discovering that the more I have, the more I need to have, the more I am loved, the more I need to be loved, the more I achieve, the more I need to achieve. Nothing seems to satisfy me. "Nothing tastes." Could it be, as someone once said, that "Our hearts are restless until they find their rest thee." Dear God, if this is true, and if as the Bible teaches there is life and life eternal in Christ alone, please guide me to him. Open me to the reality of the one who alone can satisfy my restless heart. Give me the courage to believe that which I cannot see but can understand, feel and touch through the word, sacraments and church family. Lord I want to believe, please help me in my unbelief! Amen.

Prayer of belief

Lord God, I now see that I am weaker and more flawed than I ever before believed, but in Christ, I am more loved and accepted than I ever dared hope. Even as I have not loved you or my neighbor with all of my heart, you have shown your love for me in that while I am still sinning, Christ died for me and took upon himself the condemnation that I deserve. I now know that You owe me nothing for my efforts, but you offer acceptance, love and blessing into all eternity because of Christ's efforts on my behalf. I therefore ask that you would enable me to turn away from trusting in my own efforts to gain your acceptance and forgiveness, and trust in the perfectly righteous efforts of Christ on my behalf in order to be accepted by you and entered into your holy family. And just as you raised Christ from the dead, so too I ask that you would give me a new life in Christ, one that will lead eventually to heaven itself. Thank you for Christ, and the power of the Holy Spirit to believe in him alone for my salvation. And as You have called us to follow You in baptism and in a life of committed discipleship in Your church, grant that I may take the necessary steps to be one with Your people, and live in the fullness of Your Spirit. Amen.

*Closing Hymn: Great God, What Do I See and Hear!

#321

Prayer of Thanksgiving

*Gloria Patri (# 735)

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son and to the Holy Ghost;
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be,
World without end. Amen, Amen!

*Benediction

Leader: The Lord bless you and keep you; the Lord make his face to shine upon you, and be gracious to you; the Lord lift up his countenance upon you, and give you peace. Amen. *Num. 6:24-26*

People: Thanks be to God! Hallelujah!

Postlude

*Congregation Standing

Sermon Notes

Exodus 20:1-21

The Stony-ness of the Law

Exposition:

Main Point:

Inferences: